Read for Structure, Listen to Infer

Grade 6-8 English Language Development Intervention Workbook

A 12-Week Academic Reading, Listening, and Summary Writing Program



Student Name: _____ **Class Period:** _____

Teacher Guide: Program Overview and Assessment

Welcome to **Read for Structure, Listen to Infer**. This 12-week intervention workbook supports long-term English learners in grades 6 to 8. Students develop academic reading comprehension, auditory tracking, and structured informational writing.

Weekly Instructional Schedule (Three 45-Minute Sessions)

Session	Focus Area	Key Student Activities
Session 1	Vocabulary and Explicit Modeling	Partner warm-up talk, 4 to 6 target academic terms, teacher modeling, and initial text encounter.
Session 2	Guided Practice and Graphic Mapping	Paired text analysis, graphic organizer completion, and tiered sentence frame practice.
Session 3	Independent Work and Summary Check	Independent application, higher-order defense question, and a two-question exit ticket check.

Differentiated Language Scaffolds

Support (English Levels 1 to 2): Students use provided word banks, sentence starters, and cloze graphic organizers to express complex ideas.

Challenge (English Levels 3 to 4): Students write open-ended justifications, evaluate text structures independently, and synthesize without starters.

The 8-Point Informational Summary Rubric

Use this consistent rubric to evaluate the **Baseline Summary (Lesson 1)**, **Mid-Cycle Check (Lesson 6)**, and **Final Summary Check (Lesson 12)**.

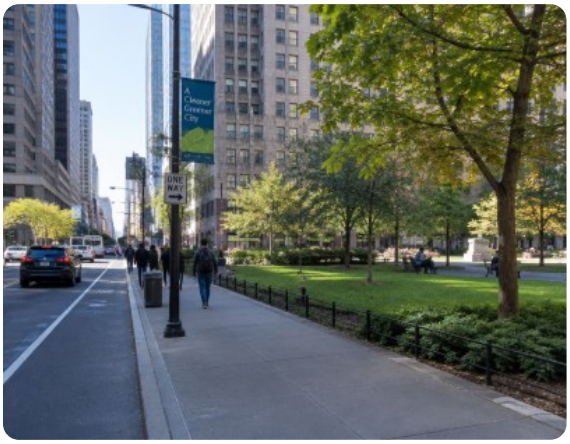
Criterion	Score: 2 (Proficient)	Score: 1 (Developing)	Score: 0 (Beginning)
1. Main Idea	Clearly states the central topic and overarching message in the opening sentence.	Mentions the general topic but misses the central point or includes minor details.	Missing, inaccurate, or states an unrelated idea.
2. Key Details	Accurately includes two essential supporting facts; skips minor illustrative examples.	Includes only one supporting fact, or keeps unnecessary illustrative examples.	Lacks factual details or copies isolated irrelevant numbers.
3. Own Words	Successfully paraphrases ideas using synonyms and altered sentence structures.	Relies heavily on copied phrases; changes only one or two isolated words.	Copies full sentences directly from the original source text.
4. Connectors	Uses two or more transition words that accurately mirror the text structure.	Uses one transition word, or uses words that do not match the structure.	Lacks transition words; sentences read as disconnected fragments.

Lesson 1: Text Structures and Signal Words

Learning Objective: I can identify five informational text structures using clue signal words. I can write a baseline 3-sentence summary of a cause-and-effect science passage.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

Look at the picture below with your partner. Why do city sidewalks feel so much hotter on a summer afternoon than the grass at a park? Discuss your ideas using the starter: *"I think cities get hotter because…"*



Partner Talk Notes: Write down one reason your partner shared:

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
structure	The way an author builds and organizes ideas.	The author chose a problem and solution **structure** for the article.
cause	The reason why an event takes place.	Heavy summer sunlight is the **cause** of warm road surfaces.
effect	The result or outcome that happens after an event.	Hot air staying overnight is an **effect** of dark concrete.
absorb	To soak in or take in liquid, light, or heat.	Dark roads **absorb** solar heat during the sunny day.
consequently	As a result; therefore.	Cities lack shade trees; **consequently**, streets stay warm.

Step 3: Informational Reading Passage

Fictional practice text

Why Cities Trap Heat

Have you ever wondered why big cities feel much warmer than nearby rural farms during the summer? Scientists call this condition the urban heat island effect. It happens because modern building materials react differently to sunlight than living plant soil. In crowded downtown areas, road crews pave wide streets with dark asphalt and construct tall buildings with dense concrete.

Dark materials absorb huge amounts of solar energy throughout sunny afternoons. As a result, city streets trap heat energy deep inside their thick masonry walls instead of reflecting it away into the sky. Consequently, when evening arrives, the stored heat slowly radiates outward into surrounding neighborhoods. Downtown avenues remain uncomfortably warm all night long, while rural grass fields cool off rapidly after sunset.

Step 4: Skill Practice and Baseline Summary

A. Signal Word Sort: Sort each transition word into its correct text structure box: *because, first, on the other hand, as a result, next, similarly*.

Cause and Effect Transitions	Sequence / Compare Transitions
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----------	----------
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B. Baseline Summary Task: Write exactly a 3-sentence summary of "Why Cities Trap Heat." Use the transition bank below. Score your summary with the 8-point summary rubric (Main Idea, Key Details, Own Words, and Connectors, 0–2 points each).

Transition Bank: *because, as a result, consequently, therefore*

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Sentence 1: *The text explains that cities get hotter than rural areas because* _____. Sentence 2: *Dark asphalt and concrete* _____ *solar energy during the day.* Sentence 3: *As a result, downtown streets* _____ *all night long.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Write your 3-sentence summary independently. Use at least two transition words from the bank to connect the cause-and-effect ideas.

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. Why did the author select a cause-and-effect structure instead of a chronological timeline to explain the urban heat island effect? Cite evidence from the text to defend your answer.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. Which signal word in the text indicates a direct outcome of dark materials soaking in heat?

☐ A) Instead ☐ B) As a result

☐ C) While ☐ D) Throughout

3. Complete this sentence frame in your own words: *Cities stay warmer at night because* _____.

Lesson 2: Distinguishing Main Ideas, Key Details, and Examples

Learning Objective: I can separate the central main idea from supporting details and illustrative examples. I can justify why an unnecessary example sentence should be cut from a summary.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

Imagine you are telling a friend about a movie. Do you retell every single scene and joke, or do you share the big story? Discuss with your partner: *"When I summarize a movie, I only tell... because..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
central idea	The most important point that anchors the entire text.	The **central idea** explains how shifting plates create volcanoes.
key detail	An essential fact that proves or explains the central idea.	Melting rock forming magma is a **key detail** in the process.
example	A specific sample that illustrates a point; can be cut.	Mentioning Mount St. Helens was a specific **example**.
relevant	Directly connected and meaningful to the main topic.	Every sentence in a good summary must be **relevant**.

Step 3: Informational Reading Passage

Fictional practice text

How Volcanoes Form

Volcanoes form because Earth's outer crust is divided into massive, shifting puzzle pieces called tectonic plates. When two plates slowly collide, one heavy plate sinks deep into the hot mantle below. Intense subterranean heat melts descending rock into a thick liquid called magma. Because magma is less dense than the solid rock surrounding it, the liquid steadily rises toward Earth's surface.

As more magma collects inside an underground chamber, trapped gas bubbles expand under great pressure. Eventually, the immense pressure forces the molten rock to burst upward through cracks in the crust. For instance, Mount St. Helens in Washington erupted violently in 1980 after a major earthquake. In addition, gift shops near Mount Rainier sell small jars of volcanic ash to tourists. Over thousands of years, repeated layers of cooled lava build a steep volcanic mountain.

Step 4: The Keep-or-Cut Routine

Review these three sentences from the reading passage. Decide whether each sentence is a **Central Idea**, a **Key Detail**, or an **Example (Cut)**.

Sentence from Passage	Category (Keep or Cut)
Volcanoes form because Earth's shifting tectonic plates collide and melt rock into rising magma.	
When pressure builds inside the underground chamber, magma bursts upward through cracks.	
In addition, gift shops near Mount Rainier sell small jars of volcanic ash to tourists.	

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Use this frame: *I should cut Sentence 3 because it is an extra [example / central idea] about tourists.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Write two sentences explaining how keeping Sentence 2 supports the scientific explanation while cutting Sentence 3 keeps the summary objective.

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. If a student removes the sentence about Mount St. Helens from their science summary, does the reader still understand how volcanoes form? Explain why or why not using the words *example* and *essential*.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. Which statement describes the job of an illustrative example in an informational text?

☐ A) It states the big umbrella topic.

☐ B) It gives a specific sample that can be cut in a summary.

☐ C) It connects two paragraphs using signal words.

☐ D) It summarizes the final concluding thought.

3. Identify which sentence is an extra example that should be cut:

☐ A) Magma rises because it is lighter than surrounding solid rock.
☐ B) For example, helicopter tours fly visitors over Hawaiian lava flows.
☐ C) Trapped expanding gases push magma upward through crust fissures.

Lesson 3: Matching Graphic Organizers to Texts

Learning Objective: I can select a graphic organizer that matches an informational text's structure. I can map cause-and-effect relationships from an animal migration text into a flow chart.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

Look at these three shapes of organizers: a **timeline**, a **comparison T-chart**, and a **cause-and-effect flow chart**. Which organizer would you use to show how a caterpillar turns into a butterfly? Tell your partner why.

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
organizer	A visual chart that arranges ideas clearly.	A graphic **organizer** helps us map text facts.
flow chart	A diagram of boxes and arrows showing a cause chain.	We used a **flow chart** to show what happens next.
migration	Moving from one region to another to survive.	Winter cold triggers the caribou **migration**.
consequence	A result produced by a preceding cause.	Finding food in the forest was a positive **consequence**.

Step 3: Informational Reading Passage

Fictional practice text

Caribou on the Move

Every fall, thousands of North American caribou begin an urgent journey across the Arctic tundra. As winter approaches, freezing temperatures stop plant growth. Because their summer food disappears under thick snow, caribou cannot survive if they stay in the far north. As a result of this severe food shortage, female caribou lead herds southward toward the sheltered boreal forest.

Deep snow and frozen rivers create serious travel barriers along the trail. The herd must walk up to thirty miles every day. Because wolf packs follow behind the migrating herd, the caribou remain close together for protection. When the animals finally reach the sheltering evergreen forests, tall trees block biting arctic winds. Consequently, the caribou find nutritious green lichen buried beneath softer snow, helping the herd survive until spring arrives.

Step 4: Skill Practice: Cause-and-Effect Flow Chart

Complete the 3-box flow chart below by mapping the causal chain from the caribou text.

Box 1: Primary Cause	**Box 2: Herd Action**	**Box 3: Final Result**
Winter cold arrives and thick snow covers summer food plants.	_____	_____

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Complete Box 2 using: *Caribou herds migrate south toward _____ to escape starvation.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Write a sentence explaining why a two-column comparison T-chart would NOT work for this caribou text.

_____

_____

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. Why does a flow chart with arrows represent this migration passage better than a chronological timeline with dates? Defend your choice by naming two signal words from the passage.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. Which signal word in the caribou passage indicates that finding lichen was a direct outcome of reaching the forest?

☐ A) While

☐ B) Because

☐ C) Consequently

☐ D) Across

3. Match each text purpose to its best visual organizer:

- Comparing two animal species side by side: _____
- Showing how one event triggers another event: _____

Lesson 4: Paraphrasing Without Changing Meaning

Learning Objective: I can paraphrase scientific sentences using synonyms and altered sentence structures. I can confirm that my restated sentence keeps the author's original meaning intact.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

If someone tells you, *"The precipitation was exceptionally heavy,"* how would you tell your younger brother what they meant? Discuss with your partner using simple words.

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
paraphrase	To rewrite someone else's idea in your own fresh words.	Good writers **paraphrase** facts rather than copy them.
synonym	A word that has the same or almost the same meaning.	The word *massive* is a **synonym** for *huge*.
restate	To express an idea again in a clearer way.	Please **restate** the scientific rule in simple terms.
convey	To communicate or express a thought or meaning.	Both sentences **convey** the same scientific truth.

Step 3: Informational Reading Passage

Fictional practice text

Inside the Magma Chamber

Deep beneath active volcanoes, molten rock collects inside massive underground reservoirs known as magma chambers. These subterranean pools sit several miles below Earth's surface, where dense rock layers subject the liquid to extreme heat and crushing pressure. As fresh magma rises from Earth's mantle, it carries dissolved gases including water vapor and carbon dioxide.

Because dense surrounding bedrock encloses the molten pool on all sides, these trapped gases cannot easily expand into the open atmosphere. Over time, fresh liquid continues surging into the chamber, causing gas pressure to build dramatically. Eventually, this tremendous force fractures the solid rock roof above the chamber. Magma surges upward through narrow conduits toward the volcanic vent, triggering an explosive eruption that coats the surrounding landscape in heavy ash.

Step 4: The 4-Step Paraphrase Routine (Read, Cover, Say, Write)

Practice paraphrasing using the synonym bank: *encloses = surrounds/traps*, *molten = liquid stone*, *cannot expand = are blocked from escaping*, *fractures = cracks/breaks*.

Original Sentence: *"Because dense surrounding bedrock encloses the molten pool on all sides, these trapped gases cannot easily expand into the open atmosphere."*

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Fill in the blanks using synonyms: *Because solid rock* _____ *the liquid stone chamber, trapped gases are* _____ *from escaping into the air.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Paraphrase this second sentence completely in your own words: *"Eventually, this tremendous force fractures the solid rock roof above the chamber."*

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. Student A wrote: *"Underground rocks explode because volcanoes are always angry."* Student B wrote: *"Over time, intense underground force cracks the thick stone ceiling of the magma chamber."* Which student wrote an accurate paraphrase? Explain why using the terms *meaning* and *accuracy*.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. Which word is the most accurate scientific synonym for **fractures** in this reading passage?

☐ A) Melts

☐ B) Cracks

☐ C) Freezes

☐ D) Covers

3. Why must a student change the sentence structure, and not just one or two words, when creating an effective paraphrase?

Lesson 5: Drafting Structured Informational Summaries

Learning Objective: I can write a 3 to 4 sentence cause-and-effect summary of an informational text. I can connect ideas using transition words like *because*, *as a result*, and *consequently*.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

What is the difference between writing a personal opinion and writing an objective summary? Discuss with your partner: *"An objective summary only includes... but leaves out..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
summary	A short restatement of main ideas in your own words.	We drafted a 4-sentence **summary** of the science article.
cohesion	How smoothly sentences link together to make sense.	Signal words give our writing clarity and **cohesion**.
objective	Based strictly on facts without personal feelings.	Keep your summary **objective** by removing your opinion.
transpiration	The process of plants releasing moisture into the air.	Plant **transpiration** helps cool rooftop surfaces.

Step 3: Informational Reading Passage

Fictional practice text

Cooling Cities with Green Roofs

Across many modern cities, urban planners are installing plant-covered rooftops to combat the urban heat island effect. Traditional dark gravel roofs absorb intense solar radiation and transfer heat directly into buildings below. In contrast, green roofs cover commercial buildings with living plant vegetation and lightweight soil layers.

Because living plants absorb sunlight and release cool moisture vapor through transpiration, rooftop surface temperatures drop significantly. As a result of this natural cooling process, buildings require far less air conditioning during hot summer months. Consequently, green roofs save electricity, lower municipal energy costs, and help reduce neighborhood heat traps.

Step 4: The 4-Part Summary Formula

Review the four building blocks of a cause-and-effect summary:

- **Sentence 1 (Topic):** State the text's central topic.
- **Sentence 2 (Cause):** Explain why the problem exists or how the action works.
- **Sentence 3 (Result):** Describe the major direct outcome using a transition word.
- **Sentence 4 (Conclusion):** Summarize the overall lasting benefit.

Summary Drafting Space: Write your 3 to 4 sentence summary of "Cooling Cities with Green Roofs".

Support (Levels 1 to 2): *First, the text explains how cities use green roofs to _____. Because plants release moisture through transpiration, rooftops stay _____. As a result, buildings require less _____ and neighborhood temperatures drop.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Write your summary independently without sentence frames. Include at least two transition words (*because*, *as a result*, *therefore*).

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. Why does including personal statements like *"I think green roofs look much prettier than gravel"* lower a student's score on the 8-point summary rubric? Explain using the term *objective*.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. Which sentence below belongs in an objective summary of the green roof text?

☐ A) Everyone should plant a garden on their roof.

☐ B) Because plants release moisture, rooftop temperatures drop.

☐ C) Traditional roofs are ugly and boring.

☐ D) Plants are my favorite part of city architecture.

3. Self-Score your summary above using the 8-point rubric:

- Main Idea: _____ / 2 | Key Details: _____ / 2 | Own Words: _____ / 2 | Connectors: _____ / 2 | **Total:** _____ / 8

Lesson 6: Synthesizing Information Across Texts (Mid-Cycle Check)

Learning Objective: I can synthesize key information from two texts using a comparison matrix. I can complete a mid-cycle 3-sentence summary evaluated on the 8-point rubric.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

Both birds and whales make long seasonal journeys every year. What is one challenge both animals face while traveling? Talk with your partner: *"Both animals must deal with..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
synthesize	To combine facts from different sources into one whole.	We can **synthesize** details from both animal articles.
integrate	To blend ideas smoothly so they work together.	Strong writers **integrate** evidence from two texts.
contrast	To look for specific differences between two topics.	We **contrast** bird flight with whale swimming.
conserve	To save, protect, or keep from being wasted.	Butterflies cluster together to **conserve** body warmth.

Step 3: Informational Dual Texts

Fictional practice text

Text 1: Arctic Terns | Arctic terns complete an incredible 44,000-mile round-trip journey every year between the Arctic and Antarctica. They travel to follow continuous summer daylight, which allows them to hunt surface fish in open waters. Because their wings are long and narrow, terns glide easily on ocean wind currents for months without landing.

Text 2: Gray Whales | Gray whales swim roughly 12,000 miles every winter from icy Alaskan seas down to warm Mexican lagoons. They leave northern waters when freezing ice covers their feeding grounds. In shallow, sheltered southern bays, mother whales give birth and nurse their young calves away from rough waves and predators.

Step 4: Guided Synthesis Matrix

Question	Text 1: Arctic Terns	Text 2: Gray Whales
Why do they travel?	To follow summer sunlight and hunt surface fish.	_____ _____
How do they travel?	_____ _____	Swimming along coastal waters to calm lagoons.

Step 5: Mid-Cycle Summary Check Passage

Fictional practice text

Monarchs on the Move

Every fall, millions of monarch butterflies leave Canada and the northern United States to travel up to 3,000 miles south to the mountain forests of central Mexico. Freezing winter weather kills adult butterflies and destroys their milkweed food source. Therefore, monarchs fly toward specific fir tree forests where dense tree branches block wind, rain, and snow. Huddled together by the thousands on tree trunks, they conserve body heat throughout the winter. When spring arrives, surviving butterflies begin traveling north again to lay eggs.

Mid-Cycle Summary Task: Write exactly a 3-sentence summary of "Monarchs on the Move." Use the transition bank below. Score your summary with the 8-point summary rubric (Main Idea, Key Details, Own Words, and Connectors, 0–2 points each).

Transition Bank: *because, therefore, in order to, consequently*

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Sentence frames: *Monarch butterflies migrate south to Mexico because _____. In the mountains, they cluster on fir trees in order to _____. Consequently, this seasonal journey helps the species _____.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Write your 3-sentence summary independently, paraphrasing key details and using at least two transition words from the bank.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Step 6: Higher-Order Defense and Exit Check

1. How does combining information from multiple animal migration texts help scientists understand animal survival better than studying only one species? Justify your thinking.

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2. Teacher Scoring for Mid-Cycle Summary (8-Point Rubric):

- Main Idea (0–2): _____ | Key Details (0–2): _____ | Own Words (0–2): _____ | Connectors (0–2): _____ | **Total:** _____ / 8

Lesson 7: Listening for Topic and Keywords

Learning Objective: I can identify the topic and main idea of a spoken talk by tracking repeated keywords. I can ask clarification questions using academic discussion frames.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up (Predict from Title)

Read the title of today's listening presentation: **"Why Middle Schools Should Start Later"**. Before hearing the talk, predict with your partner: What will the speaker's main claim be? Complete: *"Based on the title, I predict the speaker will argue that..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
topic	What a talk is about, stated in one to three words.	The **topic** of the doctor's talk was adolescent sleep.
clarify	To make an idea clearer by asking questions.	I asked a question to **clarify** what the speaker said.
auditory	Relating to the sense of hearing or sound.	We practiced our **auditory** tracking skills during the talk.
circadian	Natural 24-hour body cycles, including sleep.	Teenagers have a biological shift in their **circadian** clock.

Step 3: Teacher Spoken Script (To Be Read Aloud Twice)

> 📢 **Teacher Directions:** Do not display this text until after the exit check. Read the script aloud twice at a measured, expressive pace. Students take notes below.

Fictional practice script

"Good morning, faculty and students. Today I want to address an urgent biological reality: middle schools must shift their morning start times later. During puberty, adolescent brains experience a documented change in circadian rhythm. Specifically, the sleep-inducing chemical melatonin is released roughly two hours later at night in teenagers than in younger children or adults. Consequently, when a student must wake up at 6:00 a.m. for an early bus, their alarm clock interrupts essential deep sleep cycles. Medical research proves that teenagers require between eight and nine hours of restful sleep every night. When schools push morning start bells to 8:30 a.m., attendance rates rise, grades improve, and student sports injuries drop significantly."

Step 4: Selective Keyword Note-Taking

Listen closely as the teacher reads the presentation. Do not write full sentences. Write only repeated nouns and numbers in the boxes below:

Repeated Nouns and Key Content Words	Key Numbers and Scientific Facts
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----------	----------
----------	----------
----------	----------

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Use this clarification frame with your partner: *"Did you catch what the speaker said about [melatonin / attendance]?"*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): State the speaker's main claim and provide two pieces of evidence orally to your partner without looking at full sentences.

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. Why is tracking repeated nouns more effective than trying to write down every spoken word during a listening presentation? Defend your answer.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. What is the primary biological reason the speaker gives for why teenagers stay up later at night?

☐ A) Too much homework

☐ B) Melatonin is released two hours later

☐ C) Playing sports after school

☐ D) Early bus schedules

3. Complete the frame to state the speaker's central main idea: *The speaker argues that middle schools should start later because* _____.

Lesson 8: Tracking Spoken Signal Transitions

Learning Objective: I can recognize spoken signal transitions in real time. I can sort spoken statements into primary claims and secondary evidence on a two-column T-chart.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

When someone is speaking, how do you know if they are about to give an example, make a contrast, or wrap up? Tell your partner: *"When I hear the words... I expect the speaker to..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
signal	A spoken word that alerts the listener to what comes next.	The word *specifically* was a **signal** for numeric data.
claim	A main point or statement that someone asserts is true.	The speaker made a strong **claim** about ocean plastic.
distinguish	To recognize the clear difference between two items.	We must **distinguish** between big claims and small facts.
fragment	To break into tiny pieces or shards.	Ocean waves **fragment** large plastic bottles into pieces.

Step 3: Teacher Spoken Script (To Be Read Aloud Twice)



Teacher Directions: Read the script aloud twice. Emphasize transition cues like *first of all*, *specifically*, and *however*.

Fictional practice script

"Good morning, class. Today we are tracking ocean debris. First of all, the primary reason plastic waste builds up permanently in marine environments is extreme chemical durability. Most synthetic polymers take over four hundred years to break down. For example, over eight million metric tons of plastic beverage containers and packaging wash into our oceans every single year. However, crashing waves and solar radiation do not make this plastic disappear; instead, they shred large containers into microscopic shards called microplastics. Specifically, recent marine water sampling shows that over fifty trillion tiny plastic fragments now float across ocean surface currents, threatening delicate food webs."

Step 4: Spoken Claims and Evidence T-Chart

Sort what you heard into the two columns based on the spoken signal words:

Primary Claims (Big Points)	Secondary Proof (Numbers and Examples)
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Support (Levels 1 to 2): Word choices: *The transition [for example / however] introduced [an example of trash / a contrast about breaking into pieces].*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Explain how the spoken signal word *specifically* signaled that a precise measurement was coming next.

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. How does listening for signal words like *first of all* and *however* change how you take notes compared to just listening casually? Justify your response with an example from the talk.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. Which spoken transition word signaled the contrast that plastic does not actually disappear?

☐ A) Specifically ☐ B) First of all

☐ C) However ☐ D) For example

3. What specific data point followed the spoken signal word **specifically** in the presentation?

Lesson 9: Selective Two-Column Note-Taking

Learning Objective: I can take selective two-column notes during a spoken talk using shorthand symbols and abbreviations. I can retell key concepts aloud to a partner using only my notes.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

Why is it impossible to write down every word a teacher says during a fast presentation? What happens if you try? Share with your partner: *"If I try to write down every word, I..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary and Shorthand Symbols Key

Symbol / Term	Simple Meaning	Example Usage
→ **(Arrow)**	Leads to; causes; produces; turns into.	practice → stronger brain wires
+ (Plus Sign)	And; in addition; also; together with.	effort + 8 hrs sleep = memory
= (Equal Sign)	Equals; means; is defined as.	neuron = brain cell
neuroplasticity	The brain's ability to change and rewire through practice.	**Neuroplasticity** allows us to learn new skills.

Step 3: Teacher Spoken Script (To Be Read Aloud Twice)

📢 **Teacher Directions:** Read this science talk twice. Remind students to use the shorthand symbols (→, +, =) instead of full sentences.

Fictional practice script

"Inside your brain, there are approximately eighty-six billion tiny processing cells called neurons. When you practice a brand new skill, such as playing the guitar or solving math problems, these neurons fire electrical pulses across tiny gaps called synapses. Scientists call the brain's ability to physically reshape itself neuroplasticity. When you struggle through deliberate practice, your brain wraps the active neural pathway in a fatty protective coating called myelin. Myelin acts like rubber insulation on an electrical wire, allowing future signals to travel ten times faster. However, if you stop practicing, those connections slowly weaken. Finally, getting eight hours of sleep locks these newly formed connections into long-term memory."

Step 4: Guided Two-Column Note-Taking

Column 1: Key Ideas (Use symbols: →, +, =)	**Column 2: My Questions / Clarifications**
neuron = 86 billion brain cells --- --- --- ---	--- --- --- --- ---

Partner Retell Routine: Look ONLY at your notes. Retell the main idea and two key details to your partner in 45 seconds.

Support (Levels 1 to 2): *According to my notes, neuroplasticity means the brain [changes / stays same]. Deliberate practice leads to [stronger / weaker] connections.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Retell the complete pathway without looking at the board, explaining why both practice and sleep are required.

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. Why does using symbols like → and abbreviations help a student understand and remember a lecture better than copying whole sentences? Defend your answer.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. What does the fatty coating called **myelin** do for electrical signals in the brain?

☐ A) It shuts down neurons permanently.

☐ B) It speeds up signals up to ten times faster.

☐ C) It stops the brain from changing.

☐ D) It causes the person to fall asleep.

3. Write one note from today's talk using at least one shorthand symbol (→, +, =):

Lesson 10: Speaker Purpose, Reasons, and Evidence

Learning Objective: I can determine if a speaker intends to inform, persuade, or critique. I can identify how quantitative evidence strengthens a speaker's persuasive argument.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

Think about a commercial you saw recently. Was the person just giving you facts, or were they trying to get you to buy something? Discuss with your partner: *"I could tell they wanted to persuade me because they..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
purpose	The main goal of a speech (to inform, persuade, or critique).	The speaker's **purpose** was to convince town voters.
persuade	To convince listeners to agree with an opinion or act.	She used strong evidence to **persuade** the crowd.
stance	A speaker's position or opinion on an issue.	The scientist took a firm **stance** against plastic packaging.
evidence	Factual numbers, data, or verified facts used as proof.	Cleanup numbers provided solid **evidence** for the claim.

Step 3: Teacher Spoken Script (To Be Read Aloud Twice)



Teacher Directions: Read the speech aloud with persuasive urgency. Notice the call to action at the conclusion.

Fictional practice script

"Good evening. I urge everyone to support a complete ban on single-use plastic checkout bags in our community. Single-use bags are an environmental catastrophe for our waterways. During our annual coastal cleanup last month, six hundred community volunteers gathered more than twelve thousand discarded grocery bags from local wetlands. Biologists proved that aquatic turtles frequently mistake these floating translucent bags for jellyfish, resulting in intestinal blockage and starvation. Several neighboring communities enacted bag bans last year, and their river litter dropped seventy percent within six months. We cannot afford to delay. Please support this change today."

Step 4: Analyzing Purpose, Reasons, and Proof

Complete the analysis chart below based on what you heard in the speech:

Analysis Question	Student Response
1. What is the speaker's main purpose?	---------- ----------
2. What major reason does the speaker provide?	---------- ----------
3. What specific data point is shared?	---------- ----------

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Sentence starter: *The speaker's purpose is to [inform / persuade] listeners because they want them to [support / oppose] a ban.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Explain in writing why sharing the specific statistic "twelve thousand discarded bags" is more persuasive than simply saying "we found lots of trash."

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. How does a speaker's choice of emotional words (like *catastrophe* and *starvation*) work together with hard numbers (like *seventy percent drop*) to build a persuasive argument? Defend your answer.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. What was the speaker's primary stance in the speech?

☐ A) Opposed to city recycling rules

☐ B) In favor of banning single-use plastic bags

☐ C) Neutral about plastic packaging

☐ D) In favor of building new city landfills

3. Cite one piece of factual evidence the speaker shared to prove the ban works:

Lesson 11: Inferring from Tone and Stress

🧠 **Learning Objective:** I can make logical inferences by analyzing a speaker's vocal tone, pitch, and word stress. I can justify an unspoken meaning using the "It Says / I Think / So" routine.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

Say the sentence: *"I never said she stole my pencil"* to your partner three times. Each time, put vocal stress on a different word (*I*, *said*, *she*). How does changing your voice change the unsaid meaning?

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
inference	A logical conclusion based on clues plus what you know.	I made an **inference** about how the speaker felt.
tone	The speaker's attitude shown through vocal pitch and pace.	Her sarcastic **tone** revealed that she disagreed.
vocal stress	Extra loudness or emphasis placed on a specific word.	His **vocal stress** on *finally* showed he had waited long.
implicit	Suggested or hinted at without being stated directly.	The warning about phone use was **implicit** in his voice.

Step 3: Teacher Spoken Script (To Be Read Aloud Twice)

📢 **Teacher Directions:** Read the script aloud. In Excerpt 1, speak the word *"relax"* with exaggerated skepticism and slight laughter. In Excerpt 2, speak with urgent seriousness.

Fictional practice script

"Some students insist that scrolling social media for two hours in bed actually helps them relax before sleep… [pause, sarcastic chuckle] Sure. If your idea of relaxation is staring into bright blue light that tells your brain it is noon. When you keep your phone glowing inches from your eyes at midnight, you are essentially drinking three cups of dark roast coffee right before closing your eyes. Then you wonder why you feel like a zombie during first-period math."

Step 4: The "It Says / I Think / So" Inference Organizer

Complete the three-column organizer to determine what the doctor is implying about late-night phone use:

It Says (Spoken Clues)	I Think (My Knowledge)	So (My Logical Inference)
Speaker chuckles sarcastically and compares screens to "three cups of dark roast coffee."	Coffee has caffeine that wakes you up; chuckling means the speaker thinks something is foolish.	_____ _____ _____

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Sentence starter: *The speaker implies that checking your phone before bed [helps / ruins] your sleep because coffee [wakes you up / puts you to sleep].*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Write two sentences explaining how the speaker's vocal tone showed skepticism even though the actual word used was "Sure."

Step 5: Higher-Order Defense Question

1. A classmate says: *"The speaker said the word 'Sure,' so he must agree that scrolling phones relaxes teenagers."*How would you challenge your classmate's thinking? Use evidence from vocal tone and stress to defend your answer.

Step 6: Exit Ticket

2. What did the speaker imply by comparing looking at a phone screen to "drinking three cups of dark roast coffee"?

☐ A) Both taste very bitter.

☐ B) Both keep the brain alert and prevent deep sleep.

☐ C) Both are expensive morning habits.

☐ D) Both help students concentrate in math class.

3. What vocal cue did the speaker use to show that they did not believe scrolling relaxes students?

Lesson 12: Culminating Listening and Spoken Retell (Final Check)

Learning Objective: I can listen to an unfamiliar talk and record two-column shorthand notes. I can orally retell the talk using an 8-point listening rubric, and write a final 3-sentence summary check.

Step 1: Talk-First Warm-Up

What is a "corridor" or hallway in your school? What would a "wildlife corridor" look like in a busy city? Discuss with your partner: *"A green corridor in a city would probably connect..."*

Step 2: Academic Vocabulary

Word	Simple Meaning	Example Sentence
corridor	A continuous pathway that connects separate areas.	A green **corridor** lets animals travel between parks.
isolated	Separated from others; cut off and alone.	City roads leave wildlife **isolated** inside small parks.
biodiversity	The variety of living plants and animals in an area.	Green pathways support urban **biodiversity**.
pollinator	An insect or animal (like a bee) that carries pollen.	Bees and butterflies act as key **pollinators**.

Step 3: Teacher Spoken Script (To Be Read Aloud Twice)

Teacher Directions: Read this presentation twice. Students compile two-column notes below without looking at the text.

Fictional practice script

"Welcome, urban planning interns. Today we examine an innovative solution to wildlife habitat loss: urban green corridors. Modern metropolitan centers are dominated by vast stretches of asphalt roads and towering glass high-rises. In most major cities, more than eighty percent of native songbirds and small mammals are trapped inside isolated city parks, unable to cross dangerous multilane highways. A green corridor is a continuous, connected ribbon of native trees, rooftop gardens, and vegetated overpass bridges that links separated parks together. In two pilot cities, installing these living pathways increased native pollinator movement by nearly forty percent within two years. Furthermore, continuous plant canopies cooled surrounding street temperatures by three to five degrees. Single, isolated parks are simply not enough; our cities must build living highways to sustain urban biodiversity."

Step 4: Selective Two-Column Shorthand Notes

Key Ideas and Data (Use →, +, =)	**Speaker Tone and Inferences**
----------	----------
----------	----------
----------	----------
----------	----------

Paired Spoken Retell Task (1 Minute): Turn to your partner. Use only your notes to orally share: (1) Main Idea, (2) Two factual details, and (3) One logical inference.

Peer Retell Check (8 Points):

- Main Idea stated clearly (0–2): _____ | Two details included (0–2): _____
- Inference with spoken proof (0–2): _____ | Clear delivery (0–2): _____ | **Retell Score:** _____ / 8

Step 5: Final Written Summary Check

Fictional practice text

City Heat Traps and Tree Shading

During intense summer heatwaves, commercial city districts with minimal plant cover reach surface temperatures fifteen degrees higher than surrounding suburban neighborhoods. Concrete sidewalks, masonry walls, and dark asphalt roads rapidly soak up solar energy all day. Because these dense artificial materials hold thermal energy tightly, they release stored heat very slowly into the night air. In contrast, when city neighborhoods plant dense tree canopies over their sidewalks, leafy branches block direct sunlight from striking the pavement. As a result, shaded streets stay noticeably cooler during daytime hours. Consequently, neighborhood residents experience lower air temperatures and use less electricity for air conditioning.

Final Summary Task: Write exactly a 3-sentence summary of the passage above. Use the transition bank below. Score your summary with the 8-point summary rubric (Main Idea, Key Details, Own Words, and Connectors, 0–2 points each).

Transition Bank: *because, in contrast, as a result, consequently*

Support (Levels 1 to 2): Use these frames to write three sentences about the passage. *Sentence 1: The passage explains that city streets become very hot because _____. Sentence 2: In contrast, tree canopies _____. Sentence 3: As a result, shaded streets _____, and consequently residents _____.*

Challenge (Levels 3 to 4): Write your 3-sentence summary independently. Use at least two transition words from the bank.

Step 6: Higher-Order Defense and Exit Check

1. Based on the listening presentation, what can you infer about the speaker's opinion of cities that only build isolated, square parks without linking pathways? Cite spoken evidence to defend your inference.

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2. Final Summary Score (8-Point Rubric): Main Idea: ____ / 2 | Key Details: ____ / 2 | Own Words: ____ / 2 | Connectors: ____ / 2 | **Total:** ____ / 8

Answers

Lesson 1: Text Structures and Signal Words

Step 4A (Signal Word Sort): Cause and Effect: *because*, *as a result*. Sequence / Compare: *first*, *next*, *on the other hand*, *similarly*.

Step 4B (Baseline Summary - Model): The passage explains that big cities trap intense heat because building materials like asphalt and concrete absorb solar energy instead of reflecting it. As a result, stored thermal energy radiates into neighborhoods all night long. Consequently, downtown streets remain much hotter than rural fields.

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): The author chose cause and effect because the goal is to explain why cities get hot (the physical reason) and what happens as a result (lingering night warmth). A timeline would not work because there are no calendar dates or historical years.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) As a result. 3. Cities stay warmer at night because dark materials like asphalt absorb solar energy during the day and slowly release it after sunset.

Lesson 2: Distinguishing Main Ideas, Key Details, and Examples

Step 4 (Keep-or-Cut Routine): Sentence 1: Central Idea (Keep). Sentence 2: Key Detail (Keep). Sentence 3: Example (Cut).

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): Removing Mount St. Helens does not hurt comprehension because it is only an illustrative example of an eruption. The essential scientific process of plates colliding and magma building pressure remains complete.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) It gives a specific sample that can be cut in a summary. 3. ☑ B) For example, helicopter tours fly visitors over Hawaiian lava flows.

Lesson 3: Matching Graphic Organizers to Texts

Step 4 (Flow Chart Mapping): Box 2 (Herd Action): Female caribou lead the herd south toward the boreal forest to find food. Box 3 (Final Result): The herd finds sheltered lichen beneath softer snow and survives the winter.

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): A flow chart fits because the passage explains a chain of cause and effect (snow covers food → herd travels south → herd finds lichen). Signal words like *because*, *as a result*, and *consequently* show one event causing the next, whereas a timeline requires chronological dates.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. C) Consequently. 3. Comparing two animal species: Comparison T-Chart. Showing how one event triggers another: Cause-and-Effect Flow Chart.

Lesson 4: Paraphrasing Without Changing Meaning

Step 4 (Paraphrase Practice - Model): Over time, intense subterranean force fractures the dense stone ceiling above the underground magma chamber.

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): Student B wrote an accurate paraphrase because they restated the author's facts using synonyms (*intense force*, *fractures*) without changing the scientific meaning. Student A added an unscientific opinion (*volcanoes are always angry*).

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) Cracks. 3. Changing sentence structure ensures the writer expresses the idea in their own voice rather than plagiarizing, while preserving accurate meaning.

Lesson 5: Drafting Structured Informational Summaries

Step 4 (Drafting Summary - Model): The passage explains how cities use green roofs covered with plants to lower urban temperatures. Because living vegetation releases moisture into the air through transpiration, rooftop surfaces stay significantly cooler. As a result, buildings require less air conditioning and neighborhood heat is reduced. Consequently, green roofs save energy and protect city environments.

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): Including personal opinions lowers the score because a summary must remain strictly objective, presenting only the author's factual evidence without student feelings or personal judgments.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) Because plants release moisture, rooftop temperatures drop. 3. Self-assessment follows the 8-point rubric criteria.

Lesson 6: Synthesizing Information Across Texts (Mid-Cycle Check)

Step 4 (Synthesis Matrix): Whale Reason: To give birth and nurse calves in warm, sheltered lagoons away from ice and predators. Tern Method: Gliding on narrow wings across ocean wind currents.

Step 5 (Mid-Cycle Summary - Model): Monarch butterflies migrate thousands of miles to Mexican forests because freezing winter weather kills adults and destroys milkweed. In the mountains, they cluster together on fir trees in order to conserve body warmth and block cold wind. Consequently, this seasonal journey protects the population until spring arrives.

Step 6 (Higher-Order Defense): Combining multiple texts helps scientists identify broad biological patterns across species, showing that while animals use different travel methods, they all migrate to survive harsh seasonal changes and secure food.

Lesson 7: Listening for Topic and Keywords

Step 4 (Keyword Notes): Repeated nouns: *sleep, start times, teens, circadian rhythm, melatonin, attendance*. Numbers: *two hours later, 6:00 a.m., 8 to 9 hours, 8:30 a.m.*

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): Tracking repeated nouns allows the listener's brain to capture core concepts without falling behind. Trying to transcribe every word causes cognitive overload and leads to missing upcoming points.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) Melatonin is released two hours later. 3. The speaker argues that middle schools should start later because adolescent biology delays sleep cycles, and later starts improve attendance, grades, and health.

Lesson 8: Tracking Spoken Signal Transitions

Step 4 (T-Chart Sorting): Primary Claims: Plastic waste accumulates permanently due to chemical durability; crashing waves shred plastic into microplastics. Secondary Proof: Takes over 400 years to degrade; 8 million metric tons enter oceans annually; 50 trillion fragments float in currents.

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): Signal words act as spoken road signs. Recognizing *first of all* tells the listener to record a major claim, while *specifically* alerts them to prepare to record numerical data.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. C) However. 3. Over fifty trillion tiny plastic fragments float across ocean surface currents.

Lesson 9: Selective Two-Column Note-Taking

Step 4 (Two-Column Notes Sample): Key Ideas: *brain = 86B neurons; practice → electrical signals; struggle → myelin wraps path; myelin = 10x faster signals; no practice → weaker connections; 8 hrs sleep → locks memory*. Questions: *What is myelin made of? How long does rewiring take?*

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): Symbols like → represent complex causal relationships instantly. They free up working memory so students can concentrate on the speaker's ideas rather than handwriting mechanics.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) It speeds up signals up to ten times faster. 3. Sample: *deliberate practice → myelin insulation → 10x faster signals*.

Lesson 10: Speaker Purpose, Reasons, and Evidence

Step 4 (Purpose Analysis): 1. Purpose: To persuade listeners to support a community ban on single-use plastic bags. 2. Reason: Bags pollute waterways and harm aquatic life like sea turtles. 3. Evidence: 12,000 bags were collected by 600 volunteers; neighboring communities saw river litter drop 70%.

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): Strong persuasion pairs emotional reasoning with hard data. Emotional terms create urgency and moral concern, while numerical statistics prove the scale of the problem and verify that the proposed solution works.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) In favor of banning single-use plastic bags. 3. Neighboring communities that enacted bans saw river litter drop seventy percent within six months (or: 600 volunteers found 12,000 bags).

Lesson 11: Inferring from Tone and Stress

Step 4 (It Says / I Think / So): So: The doctor is implying that late-night screen time stimulates the brain, disrupts natural sleep hormones, and directly ruins morning classroom performance.

Step 5 (Higher-Order Defense): The classmate took the literal dictionary meaning of "Sure" without considering vocal inflection. The sarcastic chuckle, pause, and comparison to dark roast coffee prove the speaker was using irony to refute the students' belief.

Step 6 (Exit Ticket): 2. B) Both keep the brain alert and prevent deep sleep. 3. Sarcastic chuckle, skeptical pause, or vocal stress on *relax*.

Lesson 12: Culminating Listening and Spoken Retell (Final Check)

Step 4 (Two-Column Notes Sample): Key Ideas: *cities = asphalt + high-rises; 80% birds trapped in isolated parks; green corridor = ribbons of trees + gardens + bridges; corridor → +40% pollinator movement; canopy → temp drops 3-5°F.* Inferences: *urgent tone; isolated parks = failing ecosystems*.

Step 5 (Final Summary - Model): The passage explains that downtown city streets overheat during heatwaves because dense concrete and asphalt absorb solar radiation. In contrast, planting mature tree canopies blocks direct sunlight from striking the pavement. As a result, shaded streets stay cooler, and consequently, neighborhood residents use less electricity for air conditioning.

Step 6 (Higher-Order Defense): One can infer that the speaker views isolated parks as inadequate because they called them traps for eighty percent of wildlife and stated explicitly that "single, isolated parks are simply not enough" without connecting corridors.